02.Basic Variables

Sunday, March 15, 2026 3:37 PM

Built-in shell variables

→ not intended to change
→ automatically created and maintained
→ all caps

- $PWD - holds the absolute path of the current directory
- $USER - displays logged user
- $SHELL - what specific shell is running
- $HOSTNAME - hostname of the machine
- $MACHTYPE - stores system architecture

Commands:

- whoami - displays logged user
- uname - prints system's name (-a for all information)

Expansion in Bash → the shell replaces the variable's name with its actual content **before** it runs the command

Creating a variable in bash: name = text
→ stored in RAM
→ exist as long as the bash session exist

Calling a variable in bash $ name

! Quoting variables ensures their integrity

Deleting a variable : unset name

Saving the output of a command as a variable :

name = `command`

name = $ (command)